PRESS RELEASE



Sheffield-born, London-trained artist responds to Sheffield with first solo exhibition

Harrison Moore and 35 Chapel Walk Gallery Sheffield present *Sheffield: You Were History*
Opening night: Monday Sep 5th 6pm – 9pm
Exhibition continues Sep 6th – 8th 10am – 5pm

Sheffield: You Were History is the first solo exhibition by Harrison Moore (b. 1986). Drawing on research themes that include contemporary uses of steel, Sheffield's topography, Sheffield's representation in the media, labour and mass production, and local voices, this exhibition of drawings and other objects imagines Sheffield through fresh artistic perspectives. These narrative-based artworks are made through conversation and collaboration.

Harrison Moore is an artist based in London whose work spans a variety of mediums and is socially engaged and participatory. His work looks at *how* we read and ascribe value onto contemporary art and how CLASS – which he defines as our ability to know and add to culture – affects this. He holds a BA in Fine Art from Central Saint Martins, London and is undertaking an MFA in Contemporary Art Practice at the Royal College of Art, London.

The artist has said, "After living elsewhere for five years I'm now responding to Sheffield with new eyes. Is Sheffield still a relic to a steel industry no longer present? It is my feeling that Sheffield is in the midst of exploring its identity; embracing its industrial heritage in creative ways but also maturing beyond it and becoming more conscious of itself as a forward-looking place of openness and diversity. Questions concerning what has happened, what is happening now and what will happen next are important and have provided me with a rich terrain to work in. I'm trying to understand what Sheffield feels like to live in today and what it feels like to be a Sheffielder. If anything I've done prompts others to look at Sheffield with new eyes, if only for a moment, then I'll be happy with the work. My art practice often involves collaboration and input from strangers and I've been out in Sheffield for six weeks talking to people, taking video footage and collecting information from them to use in my artworks. I'm very excited to be putting on my first solo show in my hometown."

Recent group exhibitions include the Old Police Station, London; BYGDA 2.0, Stokkøya; Palais de Tokyo, Paris; Free Space Gallery, London; CSM, London; 17 Fielding Street, London; Cock & Bull Gallery, London; Black Maria, London; Mile End Art Pavilion, London; CSMSU, London; Blake College, London; and the International Museum of Tianfu Square, Chengdu.

Follow Harrison while he prepares for his exhibition:
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